AI VS AI

Calif, Wiz and OpenAI used AI to hunt PHP bugs

AI spotted a bug humans missed for 14 years.

Attackers have the same AI. Here's how the hunt works.

Swipe →

Subhadeep Ghorai

Why you should care

Bug-hunting just got faster. For everyone.

“Tools now find bugs faster than ever, for defenders and attackers alike.” (PHP Foundation)

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Subhadeep Ghorai

Al Jazeera, 22 Oct 2026

The race

Aug

Calif finds a version using GPT-5.6 Sol

Sept

OpenAI finds the full bug; Wiz finds it too

17 Oct

A honeypot logs an early attack attempt

21 Oct

Patch ships a day early after a leak

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Decrypt, Help Net Security, BleepingComputer

The idea

Proofreading a 1,000-page book.

A human skims. An AI reads every line, every night, and asks “what if?” at each one.

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How AI hunts · 1

Read the code

↓

Flag risky spots

↓

Throw weird inputs
called fuzzing

↓

Watch for crashes

Simplified view of AI-assisted bug finding.

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OUR BUILD

How AI hunts · 2

Humans confirm it

↓

Report privately
to PHP's team

↓

Fix built quietly

↓

Everyone patches

Wiz: frontier AI “substantially reduced” the barrier to exploiting it.

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Help Net Security

A fuzzer, in 6 lines

```
// throw random inputs, catch the crash
for (let i = 0; i < 10000; i++) {
  const input = randomText();
  try { parseAge(input); }
  catch (e) { console.log("Crash on:",
input); break; }
}
```

AI tools do this far smarter, at huge scale.

What it means for you

- ✔ **Update dependencies weekly: npm audit, Dependabot.**
- ✔ **Learn testing and fuzzing. It's a job skill now.**
- ✔ **Never ignore a security update.**

Decoder card

AI made bug-hunting faster. The winners are the ones who patch first.

💬 Should AI labs hunt for bugs in everyone's open-source code?

NEXT WEEK · A NEW STORY, DECODED →

Subhadeep Ghorai